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Male Dramatic Narrative U16

The Showdown for the Ages

Many years ago, during the times of the Bible, lived a prophet named Elijah. During the same time Baal, a false god, was widely worshipped. One day, Elijah got into quite the quarrel with the many followers of Baal. As he followed them to Mount Carmel, he asked, “How long will you waver between two opinions? If the Lord is God, follow him; but if Baal is God, follow him.” Obviously, the prophets said nothing.

In a quick, split-second decision, Elijah invited the prophets to a grand showdown, saying, “I am the only one of the Lord’s prophets left, but Baal has four hundred and fifty prophets. Get two bulls for us. Let Baal’s prophets choose one for themselves, and let them cut it into pieces and put it on the wood but not set fire to it. I will prepare the other bull and put it on the wood but not set fire to it. Then you call on the name of your god, and I will call on the name of the Lord. The god who answers by fire—he is God.” Immediately, the false prophets said, “What you said is good.”

Then Elijah asked the false prophets to prepare a bull to sacrifice, calling their “god” to take it. As the false prophets placed it, they called to Baal through the entire day, “Baal! Answer us.” Even as they mindlessly danced around their pointless altar, nothing happened. At noon, Elijah even teased them, saying, “Shout louder! Surely he must be sleeping.” Still, even as they slashed mindlessly with spears and swords, nothing happened.

Elijah quickly walked in and stepped near the altar, quickly commanding them, “Come here to me.” Elijah was about to show them exactly how the real God would do a sacrifice. He repaired the Lord’s altar and took twelve stones to represent the twelve tribes descended from Jacob, and recalled God’s promise, “Your name shall be Israel.” Elijah then dug a trench around the altar enough to hold two seahs of seed. He arranged the wood, cut the bull into pieces, and said to the other false prophets, “Fill

four large jars with water and pour it on the offering and on the wood.” He told them to do it again 3 times until the trench was filled with water.

Finally, Elijah showed the prophets a true sacrifice; the climax of their great showdown. He prayed to God, saying, “Lord, the God of Abraham, Isaac and Israel, let it be known today that you are God in Israel and that I am your servant and have done all these things at your command. Answer me, Lord, answer me, so these people will know that you, Lord, are God, and that you are turning their hearts back again.” Suddenly, a blast of fire fell from the heavens, blazing through every part of the altar.

Not only were Baal’s prophets shocked, everyone was. The people who were watching all fell to their knees and cried aloud, “The Lord—he is God! The Lord—he is God!” They were afraid just as they were shocked. Suddenly, Elijah fiercely asked the people to seize every prophet of Baal, and they seized them and brought them down to the Kishon Valley and slaughtered them. The winner of the showdown was clear as day: the Lord was God, and Elijah was His servant.

From the great showdown, we learn that the false gods, when tested, never succeed to usurp the throne of the only true God.